BUSS256 — R & RStudio Setup

Complete before Seminar 3

This short guide gets your computer ready for the first R session. You do not need programming experience, and nothing in this guide is graded.

1. What you need

- A Windows or macOS computer on which you are allowed to install software.
- An internet connection.
- R — the language and runtime that does the calculations.
- RStudio Desktop — the application (IDE) you will use to work with R.

Install R first, then install RStudio Desktop.

2. Install R

Install the current stable version of R. You do not need to choose a version number — the official page offers the current installer.

Official R download page: https://cran.r-project.org/

Windows	macOS
1. Choose the Windows installer. **2.** Run the downloaded file and accept the default options.	**1.** Choose the macOS installer that matches your Mac and macOS version. **2.** Open the downloaded file and follow the on-screen steps.

When the installer finishes, R is installed. You will usually use R through RStudio rather than opening R directly.

3. Install RStudio Desktop

Install RStudio Desktop only after R is installed. Use the current official download page for your operating system.

Official RStudio Desktop download page: https://posit.co/downloads/

Windows	macOS
1. Choose the Windows installer. **2.** Run it and accept the default options.	**1.** Open the downloaded file. **2.** Follow the on-screen steps to install RStudio Desktop.

Then open RStudio.

4. First launch: what you should see

When RStudio opens, you will see several areas, often called panes:

- **Source —** where an R script appears when you open one.
- **Console —** where R runs commands and shows results.
- **Environment / History —** where objects you create and recent commands appear.
- **Files / Plots / Packages / Help —** where course files, charts, packages, and help pages appear.

RStudio should find R automatically. If it cannot, see Troubleshooting.

5. Create a BUSS256 RStudio Project

A Project keeps your scripts and course files together. Use one Project folder for BUSS256.

1. In RStudio, choose File > New Project.

2. Choose New Directory > New Project, then name the project BUSS256 and choose a location you can find easily (for example, Documents).

3. Click Create Project. RStudio opens the BUSS256 Project.

4. If you already created a BUSS256 folder, choose Existing Directory instead, select that folder, and click Create Project.

Next time, open the BUSS256 Project before you start work. This keeps your scripts and files together.

6. Create an R script

1. Choose File > New File > R Script.

2. Save the script in your BUSS256 Project folder as setup_check.R (File > Save).

An R script is a text file where you write and save R commands.

7. Run the two verification checks

These are only setup checks. Type the code in setup_check.R.

Verification check 1

Run

```
1 + 1
```

Expected Console result

```
[1] 2
```

Verification check 2

Run

```
x <- c(1, 2, 3)
mean(x)
```

Expected Console result

```
[1] 2
```

The first line stores three numbers in x and prints nothing. The second line shows their mean.

8. How to run code

Place the cursor on a line, or select the code you want to run, then use the shortcut for your computer:

Windows	macOS
Ctrl + Enter	**Command + Return**

9. You're ready

If both checks show [1] 2 in the Console, your R/RStudio setup is ready for Seminar 3.

10. Short troubleshooting

If something does not work, check these first:

- Was R installed before RStudio?
- Restart RStudio after installation.
- If RStudio cannot find R, confirm that R itself was installed and opens.
- If the installer reports an unsupported OS, follow the current official guidance.
- If you do not have permission to install software, contact course or institutional support.

Note: Installation pages and system requirements can change. This guide was prepared for BUSS256 2027; use the official R and Posit download pages linked above for the current installers.